

Task 2 Band 7+ Writing Advice

A. What causes an examiner to award a grade of 7+?

1. Student actually answers the question. Off topic answers kill a score
2. Majority of sentences are mistake free
3. Evidence of advanced grammar
4. Non-repetitive language and sentence structures
5. Student does not use template language/pat language
6. The opinion/position is crystal clear
7. Ideas are explained/expanded/evidenced
8. Word count must be above 250
9. Use REAL world, objective examples
10. English COMPETENCE is evident through your language
11. Student uses subject specific vocabulary.
12. Student's foundational grammar is solid
13. Sentence variety is evident and if you have Simple Sentences, they are longer simple sentences.
14. Student does not have sentences full of functional vocabulary

B. The Planning Phase

In my opinion, this is one of the most vital parts of doing an essay and is the starting point of getting a really high score. This allows you to focus on HOW to say something and NOT WHAT to say. This stage is important.

1. Controlling Idea #1

a. Detail #1

b. Detail #2

2. Controlling Idea #2

a. Detail #1

b. Detail #2

- ***Address all parts of the question (band 7 Task response)***
- ***Organizes information logically (band 7 coherence and cohesion)***
- ***Expand and Develop your ideas (band 6 task responses can have main ideas that are inadequately developed – in other words there is a lack of balance)***

I. The introduction.

The introduction consists of two parts:

- a. It should include a few general statements about the subject to provide a background to your essay and to attract the reader's attention. It should try to explain why you are writing the essay. It may include a definition of terms in the context of the essay, etc.
- b. It should also include a statement of the specific subdivisions of the topic and/or indication of how the topic is going to be tackled in order to specifically address the question.

It should introduce the central idea or the main purpose of the writing.

II. The main body.

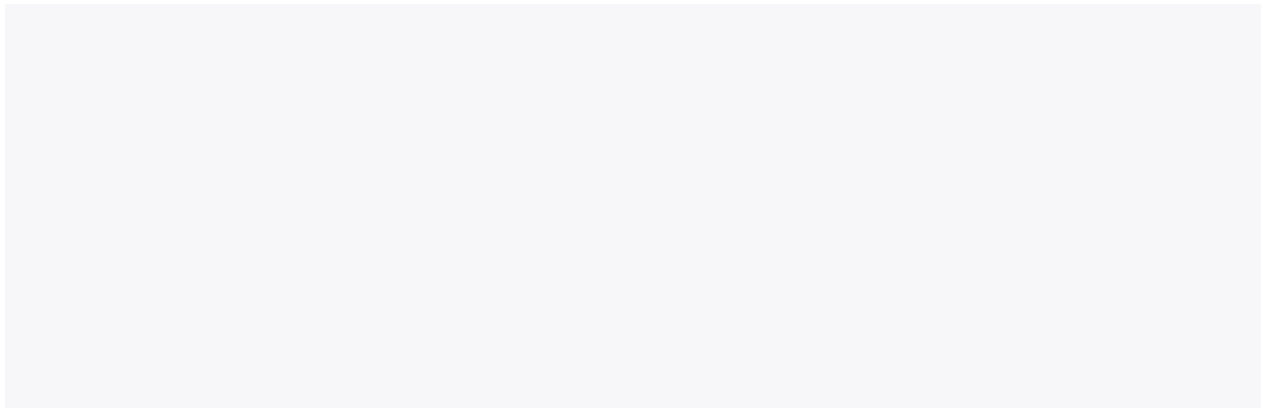
The main body consists of one or more paragraphs of ideas and arguments. Each paragraph develops a subdivision of the topic. The paragraphs of the essay contain the main ideas and arguments of the essay together with illustrations or examples. The paragraphs are linked in order to connect the ideas. The purpose of the essay must be made clear and the reader must be able to follow its development.

III. The conclusion.

The conclusion includes the writer's final points.

- a. It should recall the issues raised in the introduction and draw together the points made in the main body
- b. and explain the overall significance of the conclusions. What general points can be drawn from the essay as a whole?

It should clearly signal to the reader that the essay is finished and leave a clear impression that the purpose of the essay has been achieved.



C. How to organize a “To what extent question”? (Today’s Topic)

Here are some possible ways to answer the question.

1. **I totally/completely agree...**
2. **I totally/completely disagree...**
3. **I mostly/partly agree/disagree...**

I COMPLETELY AGREE

Introduction: State that you totally agree with the view in the question.

Body paragraph 1: State why you agree.

Body paragraph 2: State why you agree.

Body paragraph 3: State why you agree or explain why the opposite view is wrong.

Conclusion: Restate your view.

I COMPLTELY DISAGREE

Introduction: State that you totally disagree with the view in the question.

Body paragraph 1: State why you disagree.

Body paragraph 2: State why you disagree.

Body paragraph 3: State why you disagree or explain why the opposite view is wrong.

Conclusion: Restate your view.

I PARTIALLY AGREE/DISAGREE

Introduction: State the points that you agree with and the points that you disagree with.

Body paragraph 1: State why you agree with some of the points.

Body paragraph 2: State why you somewhat agree with some of the other points.

Conclusion: Restate your view.

Introduction: State the points that you agree with and the points that you disagree with.

Body paragraph 1: State why you agree with some of the points.

Body paragraph 2: State why you disagree with the other points.

Conclusion: Restate your view.

Can I just write a Discussion Essay in the place of a “To what extent essay”? NO, NO, Absolutely NOT

- Discussion both sides and give your opinion
 - You must explain both sides of what other people think and also give your opinion
- To what extent do you agree or disagree?
 - You must present your opinion and nothing else. Your opinion must cover all aspects of the essay question.

What question types lend themselves to a “partial agreement or disagreement”?

1. Two Propositions Question
2. Contrasting Ideas (Possible to believe both are true)
3. Truth of Statement Depends on Other Factors (time, place, people, context, situation)

1. Two Propositions Essay Question

Living in a country where you HAVE TO speak a foreign language can cause serious social and practical problems. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

2. Contrasting Ideas Essay Question

Some people believe that face to face communication is always more powerful than written communication. To what extent do you agree or disagree with this statement? Give your own opinion and include relevant examples.

3. Truth of Statement Depends on Other Factors Question

Some people believe that nowadays that we have too many choices. To what extent do you agree or disagree?